

Functions

CS1010 Discrete Mathematics for Computer Science

Shibam Ghosh

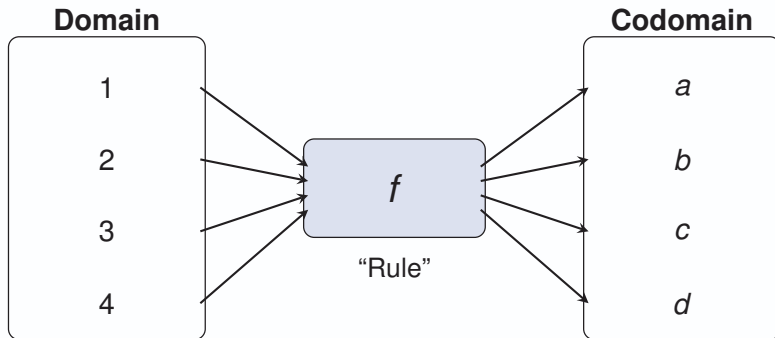
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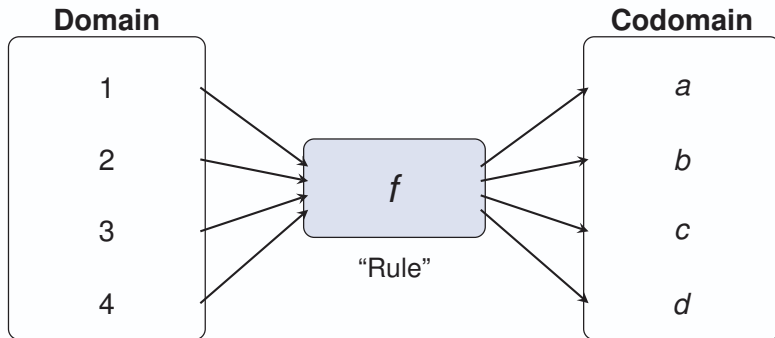
What is a Function?



Intuition

A function is a **rule** that takes an input and produces **exactly one** output.

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A Function is Like a Machine

Think of a Machine

- ▶ Put something in.
- ▶ The machine follows a rule.
- ▶ You get exactly one output.

$$f(x) = x^2$$

Input	Output
1	1
2	4
3	9
4	16



The Key Idea

Every input has one and only one output.



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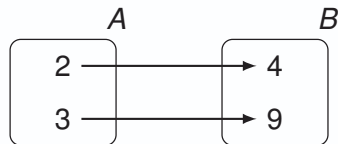
Formal Definition of a Function

Definition of function (mappings or transformations)

Let A and B be nonempty sets. A **function** f from A to B , denoted $f : A \rightarrow B$, is an assignment of exactly one element of B to each element of A .

The statement “**exactly one**” contains two requirements:

1. **Existence:** Every element of A must be assigned an output in B .
2. **Uniqueness:** No element of A can be assigned more than one output.



Notations

Given a function $f : A \rightarrow B$:

- ▶ **Domain:** Set A
- ▶ **Codomain:** Set B
- ▶ **Preimage:** If $f(a) = b$, a is the preimage of b .
- ▶ **Image:** If $f(a) = b$, b is the image of a .
- ▶ **Range:** The set of all images of elements in A . Denoted by $f(A)$.

$$f(A) = \{b \in B \mid \exists a \in A (f(a) = b)\} \subseteq B$$

Function Equality

Two functions f and g are equal if they share the same domain, codomain, and mapping values for all domain elements.



Example

Let $f : \text{Students} \rightarrow \text{Departments}$ where each student is assigned to exactly one department.

► Domain: $\{\text{Alice, Bob, Charlie, David}\}$

► Codomain: $\{\text{CSE, EE, ME}\}$

►

$$f(\text{Alice}) = \text{CSE}$$

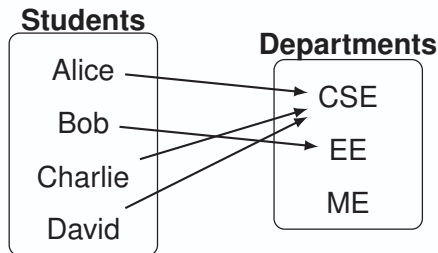
$$f(\text{Bob}) = \text{EE}$$

$$f(\text{Charlie}) = \text{CSE}$$

$$f(\text{David}) = \text{CSE}$$

► Range: $\{\text{CSE, EE}\}$

► Preimage of CSE: $\{\text{Alice, Charlie, David}\}$



Function Operations on Sets

Definition

Let $f : A \rightarrow B$ be a function, and $S \subseteq A$ be a subset of the domain. The **image of the subset** S under f , denoted by $f(S)$, is:

$$f(S) = \{b \in B \mid \exists a \in S (f(a) = b)\}$$

Exercise: From the previous example:

- ▶ Let $S = \{\text{Alice}, \text{Charlie}\}$. Find $f(S)$.
- ▶ Solution: $f(S) = \{f(\text{Alice}), f(\text{Charlie})\} = \{\text{CSE}\}$.

Injectons (One-to-One) and Surjections (Onto)

Definition

A function $f : A \rightarrow B$ is **one-to-one** or **injective** if and only if distinct domain elements map to distinct codomain elements.

- ▶ $\forall a, \forall b, (\text{ if } f(a) = f(b) \text{ then } a = b).$
- ▶ Alternatively: $\forall a, \forall b, (\text{ if } a \neq b \text{ then } f(a) \neq f(b)).$

Definition

A function $f : A \rightarrow B$ is **onto** or **surjective** if and only if every element in the codomain B is mapped to by at least one element in the domain A .

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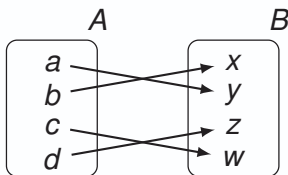
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Bijections (One-to-One Correspondence)

Definition

A function f is a **bijection** (one-to-one correspondence) if it is both injective and surjective (both one-to-one and onto).



Quick Check: Injective or Surjective?

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► Injective: Since $f(a) = f(b) \Rightarrow 2a = 2b \Rightarrow a = b$.

► Surjective: No, because odd numbers (e.g., 1, 3, 5, ...) are never images.

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A. f is both **injective and surjective**, hence bijective.

► For injectivity, $f(a) = f(b) \Rightarrow a + 5 = b + 5 \Rightarrow a = b$.

► For surjectivity, given any $y \in \mathbb{R}$, choose $x = y - 5$. Then $f(x) = y$.



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A. Because the **codomains are different**.



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A. f is **injective but not surjective**.

► If $2a + 1 = 2b + 1$, then $a = b$, so f is injective.

► Every output of f is odd. So even integers has no preimage.



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$\mathcal{A}$. **No.** Consider a nonempty string consisting entirely of 0's, such as $S = 000$. There is no position i for which the i th bit is 1, and no value for $f(S)$ is specified.



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Q. (e) $f(m, n) = m - n.$



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A. **No.** Since $m^2 + n^2 \geq 0$, no negative integer can be an output. For example, -1 has no preimage.

Q. $f(m, n) = m$.

A. **Yes.** Given any $y \in \mathbb{Z}$, choose $m = y$ and any $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, for example $n = 0$. Then $f(m, n) = y$.

Q. $f(m, n) = |n|$.

A. **No.** The output is always non-negative, so no negative integer is in the range.

Q. (e) $f(m, n) = m - n$.

A. **Yes.** Given any $y \in \mathbb{Z}$, choose $m = y$ and $n = 0$. Then $f(m, n) = y$.



Quick Check: Is the Function a Bijection?

Determine whether each function is a bijection from $\mathbb{R}$ to $\mathbb{R}$.

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A. **No.**

- It is not injective since $f(x) = f(-x)$ for every x , with $x \neq -x$ when $x \neq 0$.
- It is also not surjective: since $x^2 \geq 0$, $\frac{1}{2} \leq f(x) < 1$. Thus its range is contained in $[1/2, 1)$, not all of $\mathbb{R}$.



Some Important Functions

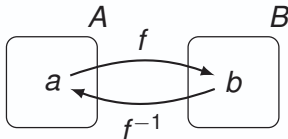
Inverse Functions

Definition

Let $f : A \rightarrow B$ be a bijection. The **inverse function** of f , denoted $f^{-1} : B \rightarrow A$, maps $b \in B$ to the unique element $a \in A$ such that $f(a) = b$.

$$f^{-1}(b) = a \iff f(a) = b$$

No inverse function exists unless f is a bijection



Why Must f Be a Bijection to Have an Inverse?

The requirement that f be bijective is essential.

- ▶ If f is **not injective**, two different elements of A may have the same image. Then the inverse would not know which element of A to choose.
- ▶ If f is **not surjective**, some element of B has no preimage. Then the inverse would not be defined on that element.

Therefore, an inverse function

$$f^{-1} : B \rightarrow A$$

exists precisely when $f : A \rightarrow B$ is bijective.



The Indicator Function

Definition

The **indicator function** (or characteristic function) of a subset A of the set X is a function $\mathbf{1}_A : X \rightarrow \{0, 1\}$ defined as:

$$\mathbf{1}_A(x) := \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } x \in A \\ 0 & \text{if } x \notin A \end{cases}$$

Example: Vowel Detection in Text Processing

Let $X = \{c, o, d, e\}$ and A be the subset of all English vowels: $A = \{a, e, i, o, u\}$.

The indicator function $\mathbf{1}_A(x)$ scans our set X and maps each character:

► $\mathbf{1}_A(c) = 0$ (since $c \notin A$)

► $\mathbf{1}_A(d) = 0$ (since $d \notin A$)

► $\mathbf{1}_A(o) = 1$ (since $o \in A$)

► $\mathbf{1}_A(e) = 1$ (since $e \in A$)



Indicator Functions and Set Operations

Let $A, B \subseteq X$ and let $\mathbf{1}_A, \mathbf{1}_B : X \rightarrow \{0, 1\}$ be their indicator functions.

► Intersection:

$$\mathbf{1}_{A \cap B}(x) = \mathbf{1}_A(x) \mathbf{1}_B(x)$$

The product is 1 exactly when both $x \in A$ and $x \in B$.

► Complement:

$$\mathbf{1}_{\bar{A}}(x) = 1 - \mathbf{1}_A(x)$$

If $x \in A$, the value changes from 1 to 0; otherwise it changes from 0 to 1.

► Union:

$$\mathbf{1}_{A \cup B}(x) = \mathbf{1}_A(x) + \mathbf{1}_B(x) - \mathbf{1}_{A \cap B}(x)$$

We subtract the intersection because its elements were counted twice.

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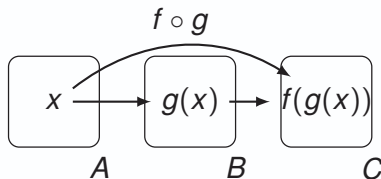
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Composition of Functions

Definition

Let $g : A \rightarrow B$ and $f : B \rightarrow C$. The **composition** of f with g , denoted by $f \circ g$, is the function from A to C defined by:

$$(f \circ g)(x) = f(g(x))$$



Remember the Order: In $(f \circ g)(x) = f(g(x))$, g is applied first, followed by f .

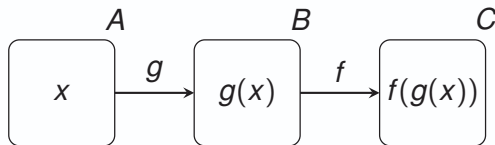
Composition: When Is It Defined?

The Key Requirement

To form $f \circ g$, the output of g must be a valid input for f .

Suppose $g : A \rightarrow B$ and $f : B \rightarrow C$.

Then the output of g lies in B , which is exactly the domain of f . Therefore, the composition is well-defined: $f \circ g : A \rightarrow C$.



Quick Check: Inverse Functions

Q. Let $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, $f(x) = 3x + 2$. Is f invertible? If so, find f^{-1} .

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Q. Can we modify the domain so that x^2 becomes invertible?

$\mathcal{A}$. Yes. Consider $f : [0, \infty) \rightarrow [0, \infty)$, $f(x) = x^2$. This function is bijective, and therefore $f^{-1}(x) = \sqrt{x}$.



Quick Check: Invertibility and Codomain

Q. Consider $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}, f(x) = e^x$. Show that f is not invertible. What happens if we change the codomain to $\mathbb{R}^+$?

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A. **As a function** $\mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$: f is not surjective. Since $e^x > 0$ for every $x \in \mathbb{R}$, no negative real number or 0 occurs as an output. Hence, $f(\mathbb{R}) = (0, \infty) \neq \mathbb{R}$. Therefore, f is not bijective and has no inverse $f^{-1} : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$.

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Q. Now consider $g : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^+, g(x) = e^x$. Is g invertible?

A. **Yes.** The function is injective because $e^a = e^b \implies a = b$. It is also surjective onto $\mathbb{R}^+$ because for every $y > 0$, choosing $x = \ln y$ gives $g(x) = e^{\ln y} = y$.

Quick Check: Function Composition

In each question, find $(f \circ g)(x)$ and $(g \circ f)(x)$.

2. Let $f : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, $f(x) = x + 2$ and $g : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$, $g(x) = 3x$.

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A. $(f \circ g)(x) = f(3x) = 3x + 2$, and $(g \circ f)(x) = g(x + 2) = 3(x + 2) = 3x + 6$.

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A. $f \circ g$ **is defined** because g maps into $\mathbb{R}$, which is the domain of f .

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Composition and Bijections

Let $g : A \rightarrow B$ and $f : B \rightarrow C$.

Q. Suppose that f and g are both one-to-one. Show that $f \circ g$ is one-to-one.

A. Let $x, y \in A$ with $x \neq y$.

- ▶ Since g is one-to-one, $g(x) \neq g(y)$.
- ▶ Since f is one-to-one, $f(g(x)) \neq f(g(y))$.
- ▶ Therefore, $f \circ g$ is one-to-one as $(f \circ g)(x) \neq (f \circ g)(y)$.

Q. Suppose that f and g are both onto. Show that $f \circ g$ is onto.

A. Let $y \in C$ be arbitrary.

- ▶ Since f is onto, there exists $b \in B$ such that $f(b) = y$.
- ▶ Since g is onto, there exists $x \in A$ such that $g(x) = b$.
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Composition and Surjectivity

Let $g : A \rightarrow B$ and $f : B \rightarrow C$.

Q. Suppose that $f \circ g$ is onto. Prove that f must also be onto.

A. Let $y \in C$ be arbitrary. Since $f \circ g$ is onto, there exists some $x \in A$ such that

$$(f \circ g)(x) = y. \implies f(g(x)) = y.$$

Since $g(x) \in B$, we have found an element of B , namely $g(x)$, that is mapped by f to y . Thus, every $y \in C$ has a preimage under f . Hence,

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Composition and Injectivity

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Applying f to both sides gives

$$f(g(x)) = f(g(y)). \implies (f \circ g)(x) = (f \circ g)(y).$$

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Composition: An Important Theorem

Theorem

Let $g : A \rightarrow B$ and $f : B \rightarrow C$, and suppose that $f \circ g$ is a bijection. Then, g is **onto** if and only if f is **one-to-one**.

Proof. ($\Rightarrow$) Suppose g is onto. Let $b, b' \in B$ and suppose $f(b) = f(b')$.

► Since g is onto, there exist $x, x' \in A$ such that $g(x) = b, g(x') = b'$. Thus,

$$(f \circ g)(x) = f(b) = f(b') = (f \circ g)(x').$$

► Since $f \circ g$ is one-to-one, $x = x'$, and hence $b = b'$. Therefore, f is one-to-one.

($\Leftarrow$) Suppose f is one-to-one. Let $b \in B$.

► Since $f(b) \in C$ and $f \circ g$ is onto, there exists $x \in A$ such that $(f \circ g)(x) = f(b)$.

► Hence, $f(g(x)) = f(b)$. Since f is one-to-one, $g(x) = b$. Thus every $b \in B$ has a preimage under g , so g is onto.



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- ▶ Since g is onto, there exist $x, x' \in A$ such that $g(x) = b, g(x') = b'$. Thus,

$$(f \circ g)(x) = f(b) = f(b') = (f \circ g)(x').$$

- ▶ Since $f \circ g$ is one-to-one, $x = x'$, and hence $b = b'$. Therefore, f is one-to-one.

($\Leftarrow$) Suppose f is one-to-one. Let $b \in B$.

- ▶ Since $f(b) \in C$ and $f \circ g$ is onto, there exists $x \in A$ such that $(f \circ g)(x) = f(b)$.
- ▶ Hence, $f(g(x)) = f(b)$. Since f is one-to-one, $g(x) = b$. Thus every $b \in B$ has a preimage under g , so g is onto.

Composition: An Important Theorem

Theorem

Let $g : A \rightarrow B$ and $f : B \rightarrow C$, and suppose that $f \circ g$ is a bijection. Then, g is **onto** if and only if f is **one-to-one**.

Proof. ($\Rightarrow$) Suppose g is onto. Let $b, b' \in B$ and suppose $f(b) = f(b')$.

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($\Leftarrow$) Suppose f is one-to-one. Let $b \in B$.

- ▶ Since $f(b) \in C$ and $f \circ g$ is onto, there exists $x \in A$ such that $(f \circ g)(x) = f(b)$.
- ▶ Hence, $f(g(x)) = f(b)$. Since f is one-to-one, $g(x) = b$. Thus every $b \in B$ has a preimage under g , so g is onto.



Quick Check: A Counterexample

Q. Find functions $g : A \rightarrow B$ and $f : B \rightarrow C$ such that $f \circ g$ is a bijection, but g is not onto and f is not one-to-one.

A. Consider

$$A = \{1, 2\}, \quad B = \{a, b, c\}, \quad C = \{x, y\}.$$

- ▶ Define $g : A \rightarrow B$ by $g(1) = a, \quad g(2) = b$.
- ▶ Thus, g is **not onto**, since c is not in its range.
- ▶ Define $f : B \rightarrow C$ by $f(a) = x, \quad f(b) = y, \quad f(c) = x$.

Thus, f is **not one-to-one**, since $f(a) = f(c) = x$.

However, $(f \circ g)(1) = f(a) = x, (f \circ g)(2) = f(b) = y$. Therefore,

$$f \circ g : \begin{cases} 1 \mapsto x, \\ 2 \mapsto y, \end{cases}$$

which is both one-to-one and onto.

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Quick Check: Injectivity of a Composition

Let $g : A \rightarrow B$ and $f : B \rightarrow C$.

Q. If f and $f \circ g$ are one-to-one, does it follow that g is one-to-one? Justify your answer.

A. Yes. In fact, we do not even need to assume that f is one-to-one.

- ▶ Suppose $g(x) = g(y)$ for some $x, y \in A$.
- ▶ Applying f to both sides gives $f(g(x)) = f(g(y))$. Therefore,

$$(f \circ g)(x) = (f \circ g)(y).$$

- ▶ Since $f \circ g$ is one-to-one, $x = y$. Hence,

g is one-to-one.

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- Since $f \circ g$ is one-to-one, $x = y$. Hence,

g is one-to-one.

Quick Check: Surjectivity of a Composition

Let $g : A \rightarrow B$ and $f : B \rightarrow C$.

Q. If f and $f \circ g$ are onto, does it follow that g is onto? Justify your answer.

A. No. Consider

$$A = \{1\}, \quad B = \{a, b\}, \quad C = \{x\}.$$

- ▶ Define $g(1) = a$ and $f(a) = x$, $f(b) = x$. Then f is onto because x has a preimage.
- ▶ Also, $(f \circ g)(1) = f(a) = x$, so $f \circ g$ is onto.

However, g is **not onto**, since $b \in B$ has no preimage under g .

Thus,

$$f \text{ onto and } f \circ g \text{ onto} \not\Rightarrow g \text{ onto.}$$

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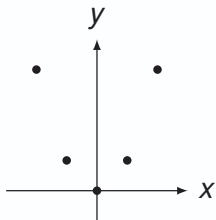
Graphs of Functions

Definition

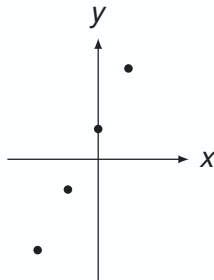
Let $f : A \rightarrow B$ be a function. The **graph** of f is the set of ordered pairs:

$$\{(a, b) \mid a \in A \wedge f(a) = b\}$$

Graph of $f(x) = x^2$ from $\mathbb{Z}$ to $\mathbb{Z}$:



Graph of $f(n) = 2n + 1$ from $\mathbb{Z}$ to $\mathbb{Z}$:





Thank You for your
attention!

Any questions?